Santgurlal Singh

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SUMMARY

Software engineer with 7+ years building and scaling consumer products used by millions, across ticketing, payments and live events. Work across the stack, from user-facing apps to APIs and services, and own products from the first requirement to launch and beyond. Experienced in high-traffic systems where speed, search visibility, reliability and security directly affect revenue. Ship high-stakes launches on short deadlines while keeping code quality high, and bring AI into both the products and the way they are built. Work closely with product, design and business teams to turn unclear problems into features that ship.

EXPERIENCE

SDE 3 (Tech Lead) · District by Zomato — Aug 2024 – Present

Zomato's going-out app for movies, live events and dining (10M+ downloads). Lead an engineering team that owns movie ticketing, live events and payments across the app and website.

- Lead a team of engineers through sprint planning, code review, mentoring and hiring; wrote the team's **code review standard** and an AI agent that reviews pull requests against it.
- Built the core movie-booking flow for District's launch (seat selection, offers, pricing, payments) and now own movie booking in the app, on district.in/movies and on TicketNew, handling **peaks of tens of thousands of requests a minute** and billions a year with a 99.99%+ success rate.
- **More than doubled** the web share of movie orders in a year by leading SEO for movie pages (structured data, internal linking, canonical URLs, sitemaps, restoring de-indexed pages) and growing organic search clicks 22.5% in one quarter.
- Built cashless wristband payments for concerts and festivals (online top-up, refunds, offers, food ordering), live at major shows including Enrique Iglesias, where **thousands of fans topped up their bands over two nights**, and Rolling Loud India; also launched District's first concert-to-dining offer, where topping up the band unlocks a restaurant deal for after the show.
- Built the launch page and end-to-end purchase flow (product listing, size selection, cart, checkout) for One8's debut sneaker drop with Virat Kohli; the drop sold out within minutes, drawing **buyers from across India**.
- Moved TicketNew onto District's platform with **no downtime or broken booking flows**, and own its movie booking on the website and inside the TicketNew app, serving millions of requests a day and **10M+ on peak days** with a 99.99%+ success rate.
- Built indoor navigation for malls, live at Nexus Select Citywalk, New Delhi: step-by-step directions using landmarks (shops, escalators, food court) where GPS doesn't work; **every route in the mall is tested automatically** before each release, and a map editor lets the operations team add new venues without engineers.

Senior Software Engineer · Paytm (Movies and Ticketing) — Sep 2021 – Aug 2024

Movie ticketing on the Paytm app, Paytm's movie website and TicketNew; the business was acquired by Zomato in Aug 2024.

- Moved the movies platform from React to Next.js with server-side rendering (SSR), improving SEO performance by **about 50%** and cutting Time to Interactive by about 40%.
- Launched and scaled movie booking across the Paytm app (**350M+ active users**) and website (millions of daily users), with a fast, consistent experience on both.
- Rebuilt the TicketNew website end to end (**100K+ daily active users**) and was the sole owner of the Paytm Movies website, accountable for performance, feature delivery and long-term maintainability.
- Mentored junior developers, ran code reviews and drove the adoption of reusable components and performance-focused practices.

Full Stack Developer (MERN) · App-knit, Chandigarh Jun 2019 – Sep 2021

- Independently built and deployed **7+ full-stack applications** for clients in e-commerce, social, music, dating and logistics, including the BEATBoXX music app on the App Store.
- Delivered features on schedule across parallel projects, working closely with designers and product managers in Agile sprints.

SKILLS

Core stack: TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, Express, React, Next.js, GraphQL, REST APIs, HTML, CSS

Data and infrastructure: MongoDB, PostgreSQL, SQL, Redis, Kafka, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS (ECS, CodeBuild)

Engineering: System design, performance, technical SEO, server-side rendering (SSR), application security, accessibility, offline-first apps, analytics, CI/CD

Product areas: Checkout and payments, live events, search and discovery, design systems, admin and internal tools

Testing and tooling: Vitest, Playwright, Datadog (monitoring), Redux, Zustand, pnpm, three.js

AI: Claude and Gemini APIs, agentic coding and review workflows, generative image features

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Computer Science and Engineering · Amritsar College of Engineering and Technology 2015 – 2019

LANGUAGES

English, Hindi, Punjabi